

CEO

Eleanor Marsh, Mutual Founder

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE  
◆ 5

SIGNATURE  
Signature: one copy per deck.  
Requires a Life funding source.  
Each Mortality clause costs you 1 less Surplus.  
Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Mortality clauses.  
Started the company in 1952 with a card table and a mortality table, and still uses both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 199 / 374

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN  
◆ 3 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.  
At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.  
At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).  
Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 355 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 turn start

STAPLE  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation  
Staple: any number per deck.  
If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.  
Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 turn start

STAPLE  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation  
Staple: any number per deck.  
If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.  
Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 turn start

STAPLE  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation  
Staple: any number per deck.  
If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.  
Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 turn start

STAPLE  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation  
Staple: any number per deck.  
If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.  
Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN  
● 1 turn start

STAPLE  
▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation  
Staple: any number per deck.  
If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.  
Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 001 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE



CAPACITY  
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST  
● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity  
Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.  
Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 002 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Accelerated Underwriting

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Mortality ▲ Regulation ▼ Longevity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No needles, no doctor visits, just an algorithm that's fairly sure you're fine.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 004 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Indexed Universal Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Short-Term Equity ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A life product wearing an equity-market jacket.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 005 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

## Life & Health Combo

LIFE · HEALTH

CAPACITY

MARGIN

1

Leverage a turn

1

run start

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Life and health coverage in one benefits portal nobody remembers the password to.

L

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 006 / 374

INVESTMENT

## Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST

YIELD

SALE

2

1 each turn

1 any time

▲ Inflation

▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 374

INVESTMENT

## Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST

YIELD

SALE

2

1 each turn

1 any time

▲ Inflation

▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 374

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

## Affiliate Loan

ILLIQUID

DARK

COST

YIELD

2

2 each turn

DARK

SIGNATURE

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Destroyed if Whistleblower or Market Conduct Exam hits you.

The float was invested conservatively, in companies owned by the insurer's owner.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 086 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

## Mortality Retrocession

TREATY

COST

2

Requires a Life funding source.

Halve your loss from Mortality clauses (round down).

Someone else can worry about the tail of the mortality curve.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 114 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

## Mortality Retrocession

TREATY

COST

2

Requires a Life funding source.

Halve your loss from Mortality clauses (round down).

Someone else can worry about the tail of the mortality curve.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 114 / 374

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

## Cat Bond Sponsorship: Mortality

TREATY

COST

2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Life or Health funding source.

When Mortality clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Capital-markets investors take the pandemic tail, for a price.

L

H

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 123 / 374

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

## Side Letter

TREATY

DARK

COST

CARRYING COST

3

1 each turn

DARK

SIGNATURE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Risk transfer on the cover page, and a letter in the drawer saying the reinsurer gets it all back.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 142 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

## Quota Share Treaty

TREATY

COST

CARRYING COST

2

1 each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 112 / 374

## Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

*Share the premium, share the pain.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 112 / 374

## Too Big to Fail

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

*Signature: one copy per deck.*

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus. If all remaining players become insolvent because of this, you win the game.

*What regulators call interconnectedness, your rivals call a hostage situation.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 139 / 374

## Fitness Trackers

HARDWARE



PRICE

◆ 2

▲ Cyber

Requires a Life or Health funding source.

Each Mortality clause costs you 2 less Surplus.

*Ten thousand steps a day earns the discount, and several policyholders' dogs now qualify.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 371 / 374

## Medical Director

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 5

Requires a Life funding source.

Your Life funding sources have +1 Margin.

*Knows which applicants are fine and which are 'fine.'*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 374

## Business School Dean

ACADEMIC



HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for an employee, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

*Knows every alum worth hiring, and which ones owe the annual fund.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 212 / 374

## Mortality Researcher

RISK &amp; COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Requires a Life funding source.

**Commit** this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Mortality clauses.

*Spots the trend in the claims data a quarter before anyone else does.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 177 / 374

## Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.

*The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 374

## Rating Downgrade

REPUTATION



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on their board, plus 3 more. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

*One notch, and the brokers stop returning calls.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 277 / 374

## Reserve Charge

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 7

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per funding source they control.

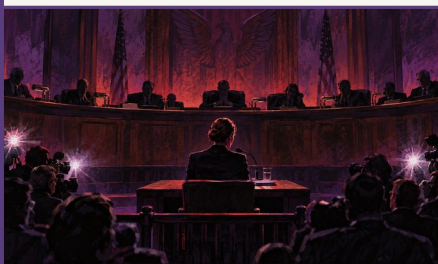
*A one-time charge, for the fourth year running.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 289 / 374

## Congressional Hearing

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

## ESCALATE

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 1 per Dark card on their board.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Feeder Fund it controls.

*I don't recall, Senator. I'd have to check with my team. My team has been let go.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 299 / 374

## Rated Feeder Note

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Basel III Endgame or Solvency II hits you.

*The same private loans, sliced so the capital charge drops from thirty percent to four.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 085 / 374

## Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Short-Term Equity ▼ Inflation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Dash for Cash, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Great Depression hits you.

*Marked to model, quarterly.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 071 / 374

## Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

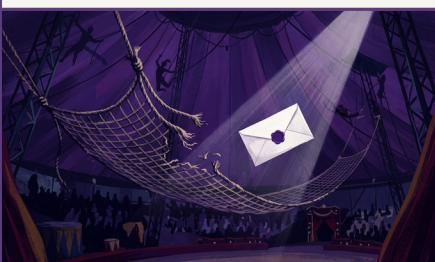
*The flag is a big plus!*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 352 / 374

## Reinsurer Insolvency

MARKET



COST

◆ 1

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Risk Management card to discard, chosen by the runner.

*The treaty was airtight. The reinsurer was not.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 335 / 374

## License Suspension

REGULATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one funding source to discard, chosen by the runner.

*The letter was two paragraphs long, and the second paragraph was the one about ceasing to write new business.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 334 / 374

## Hurricane Katrina

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2005



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Flood ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

*In August 2005, Hurricane Katrina struck the Gulf Coast, and failed levees left about 80 percent of New Orleans under water.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 235 / 374

## 1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

*Surprise trust fall.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 252 / 374

## mRNA Breakthrough

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

*A platform built for one virus turns out to work on a lot of things.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 246 / 374

## The \$1,000 Pill

HEALTH · AS-IF REPLAY, 2014



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Health Price exposure.

In 2014, Sovaldi, a new cure for hepatitis C, cost \$1,000 a pill, \$84,000 for a course, and health plans' drug bills jumped. Bandages now come with a payment plan.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 248 / 374

## Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 270 / 374

## Great Depression

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 1929



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Credit exposure, and 2 per investment it controls.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In October 1929, the U.S. stock market crashed, and by 1933 about a quarter of American workers had no job.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 273 / 374

## Roundup Verdict

LITIGATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2018



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

In August 2018, a San Francisco jury ordered Monsanto to pay \$289 million to a groundskeeper who blamed its weedkiller, Roundup, for his cancer.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 283 / 374

## Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity  
▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 374

## 1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 262 / 374

## Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 302 / 374

## Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 287 / 374

## 2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 374

## AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

*On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 285 / 374

## Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

### ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

*On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 340 / 374

## Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

*In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 374

## Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

### SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

*In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 306 / 374